



HSBC Software Engineer Intern

Internship Acceptance Guide

A complete guide for aspiring interns

Student's Experience & Suggestions

Aritra Chatterjee

1 Computer Science & Engineering

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Year of Grad.	2027

Experience

Round 1: Aptitude (2 hours)

The process began with the Aptitude round (28th Sept) which consisted of English, Maths, Mental Ability and Situation-based questions. Questions were of easy level and almost all the people who gave this round were shortlisted.

Round 2: Codility (100 minutes)

This was followed by the Codility round (29th Sept) which consisted of 3 DSA questions of LC Easy to Medium difficulty. Around 10 people were shortlisted for the interview.

Round 3: Technical Interview (30 minutes)

The interview was held on 10th October. The Technical Interview began with an introduction of myself and about my previous internship. This was followed by 2 DSA questions:

- Palindrome checking (very easy)
- A question on gym membership (this was a question some people were asked in the Codility round, so I knew the approach beforehand)

This was followed by some basic questions on React: React Router, React DOM, and lazy loading. Then some basic OOPs questions were asked like abstract class and composition. Following this, some questions were asked about my research paper on Stock Price Prediction. The interviewer was quite friendly and also asked me about my hobbies and my favourite Indian footballer. This round lasted about 25–30 minutes.

Round 4: HR Round (10–15 minutes)

3 candidates were shortlisted for the HR round. This was more of a cultural fit check — the interviewer asked about my location preferences and how I would utilise my skills during my internship. This round lasted about 5–7 minutes for me; for others it was around 10–15 minutes max.

All 3 got selected finally.

Preparation Tips

HSBC focuses a lot on your CV. Make sure you know your CV from the bottom up.

Knowing the basics of Web development / ML and CS fundamentals (as mentioned in your CV) is more than sufficient for cracking an intern at HSBC. The DSA questions asked were also of LC Easy to Medium type.

Make sure to go through the DSA questions asked in the coding round just in case.

And of course, you need a pinch of luck. All the best!

✓ **Selected**

Pavel Das

2 Computer Science & Engineering

Name	Pavel Das
Department	Computer Science & Engineering
Year of Grad.	2027

Experience

Round 1: Technical Interview

The interviewer asked me to introduce myself and, with the flow, move on to my projects. I mentioned the website I built during my SIH finals. He asked about my contribution in the group project. I did most of the talking about the features and functionalities on Authentication (login and signup). He said I pre-answered most of his questions but still asked about JWT's structure and how the password is checked from the database (i.e., if the password is decrypted, it is not safe). He asked how to protect the JWT_SECRET_KEY from GitHub as anyone can access it (answer: .env). He looked satisfied with all answers, then asked a simple DSA question:

- Make the maximum number from another number. [Input: 15387 → Output: 87531]

Round 2: HR Round

The next interview was very light-hearted. He asked about leadership skills required to be the leader of a hackathon team, and gave 2–3 situations to see how I would overcome them. Then he asked where I live (he was also from Kolkata). He then told me about the role of the intern, and that was it.

Preparation Tips

Don't include things in your CV that you don't have knowledge about, as everything they ask is from your CV. The technical round was easy for everyone and the interview was short, so try to stand out by giving in-depth answers to impress the interviewer.

✓ **Selected**